

very serious expression, “I’m going to go to bars in West Palm Beach and find a rich man to marry me.” I thought she was kidding, but I saw Veronique a year later at a bar in West Palm Beach flirting with a man. I couldn’t help but wonder if she was still looking.

Veronique had closed herself to all solutions to her financial problems except for the “shining knight” scenario. Unfortunately, this solution has a low success rate. She may find her shining knight, but is his money the only shining thing about him? Veronique could end up in a loveless relationship just to pay her bills.

If Veronique had been willing to try to cut back on some of her expenses, she might actually have solved her dilemma herself. Not having to rely on a man for his money could open up many more possibilities in her choice of a mate.

While Waiting to Win the Lottery

Being unwilling to try and increase the income available is just as self-defeating as being averse to making cuts in expenses. Increasing your income can sometimes be the solution to a budget imbalance, especially if you have already made as many reductions in your expenses as possible.

A young nineteen-year-old single mother named Nora came in for credit counseling. She had charged her credit cards to the max and, combined with her other expenses, was having a hard time making all her payments. Nora wasn’t trying to collect child support, which would have helped her situation. She figured that it was a waste of time since the father wasn’t employed; he was a student. He had graduated and went on to college like she had planned to do prior to becoming pregnant. Because of her child, she had dropped out of high school and was living on welfare.

The counselor discussed with Nora the various options she had to increase her income. She could look into free childcare

